Methodology and Sample Descriptive Statistics

A Question of Commitment: Investigating how Citizens Perceive Parties' Programmatic Responses to Competition

Fabian Habersack

Methodology

Survey design and sample size: The survey data constitute a representative sample of the voting-eligible population of Austria, with access to the internet. The sample size is N = 2,013 completed interviews. Quotas were set for gender, age, federal state, and education level to match the distribution of these characteristics in the general population (see: https://www.statistik.at/en). Participants were required to be at least 16 years old. The questionnaire consists of a total of 21 questions, including demographic statistics. It includes a vignette treatment as well as post-treatment manipulation checks and attention checks.

Field work and data collection: The survey was conducted using an online panel managed by MARKET Institute. This panel consists of approximately 30,000 individuals who were predominantly recruited offline through nationwide telephone and personal interviews, ensuring a representative sample. MARKET does not purchase email addresses or rely on contest entries from other companies. The data collection process involved programming and fieldwork execution by MARKET Institute. The collected data was delivered as a labelled raw dataset; open-ended questions were not coded or proofread. Field work commenced on 3 March 2023 and ended on 14 March 2023. In total, about 2,600 individuals were contacted to achieve 2,013 valid interviews.

Anonymity and Data Protection: MARKET Institute adheres strictly to anonymity and data protection guidelines. Responses were processed in an anonymized form, ensuring no individual could be identified. Compliance with the Austrian Data Protection Act (DSG) and the General Data Protection Regulation (DSVGO) was maintained, along with adherence to the ICC/ESOMAR Code of Conduct. The data file contains a numeric ID (1–2,013) and is fully anonymized.

Acknowledgements

This research was supported by the University of Innsbruck through the Early Stage Funding scheme (grant number 366657). I am grateful for the financial support, which made the data collection for this study possible.

Suggested citation

Habersack, Fabian, 2024, "A Question of Commitment: Investigating how Citizens Perceive Parties' Programmatic Responses to Competition - Method Report", https://doi.org/10.11587/R51DRM, AUSSDA.

This document is licensed under the Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International License.

Table 1: Sample descriptive statistics

Variable	Mean	SD	Median	Min	Max	Missing
Q1	1.94	0.80	2	1	4	0.00%
Q2	3.48	2.76	2	1	12	5.00%
Q3x1	4.54	3.41	5	0	10	3.00%
Q3x2	3.76	3.56	3	0	10	2.00%
Q3x3	2.68	3.74	0	0	10	3.00%
Q3x4	3.82	3.61	3	0	10	3.00%
Q3x5	3.62	3.24	3	0	10	3.00%
Q3x6	2.00	2.87	0	0	10	4.00%
Q3x7	1.26	2.61	0	0	10	4.00%
Q3x9	5.32	3.74	6	0	10	92.00%
Q4	4.11	2.63	3	1	9	92.00%
Q5	8.37	1.80	9	0	12	2.00%
Q6x1	3.44	1.11	4	1	5	0.00%
Q6x2	1.80	0.89	2	1	5	0.00%
Q6x3	2.14	0.98	2	1	5	0.00%
Q6x4	3.24	0.97	3	1	5	0.00%
Q6x5	3.41	1.09	3	1	5	0.00%
Q6x6	3.44	0.97	3	1	5	0.00%
Q7x1	2.19	0.99	2	1	5	0.00%
Q7x2	1.98	0.83	2	1	5	0.00%
Q7x3	2.37	1.04	2	1	5	0.00%
Q7x4	2.57	0.94	3	1	5	0.00%
Q8x1	4.97	2.81	5	0	10	0.00%
Q8x2	3.75	3.14	3	0	10	0.00%
Q8x3	7.14	3.27	8	0	10	0.00%
Q8x4	3.90	3.10	4	0	10	0.00%
Q8x5	6.01	3.30	6	0	10	0.00%
Q8x6	6.45	2.51	6	0	10	0.00%
Q8x7	3.78	2.95	3	0	10	0.00%
Q8x8	4.59	3.23	5	0	10	0.00%
Q8x9	6.21	3.36	6	0	10	0.00%
Q9	5.39	3.03	5	0	10	11.00%
Q10	2.30	0.91	2	1	4	16.00%
Q11x1	6.42	3.31	7	0	10	6.00%
Q11x2	2.81	2.82	2	0	10	15.00%
Q12	8.38	1.79	9	0	12	2.00%
Q13x1	3.46	1.09	4	1	5	0.00%
Q13x2	1.84	0.93	2	1	5	0.00%
Q13x3	2.18	1.00	2	1	5	0.00%
Q13x4	3.17	0.98	3	1	5	0.00%
Q13x5	3.50	1.08	3	1	5	0.00%
Q13x6	3.48	0.98	3	1	5	0.00%
Q14	1.54	0.86	1	1	3	26.00%
Q15	4.36	3.03	4	1	10	27.00%
Q16	1.49	0.50	1	1	2	0.00%
Q17	47.53	16.26	46	18	81	0.00%
Q18	5.47	2.48	5	1	9	0.00%
Q19	6.77	2.35	6	2	12	0.00%
Q20	1.83	1.52	1	1	9	1.00%
Q21	2.05	0.79	2	1	4	1.00%

Variable distributions

Figure 1: Political interest

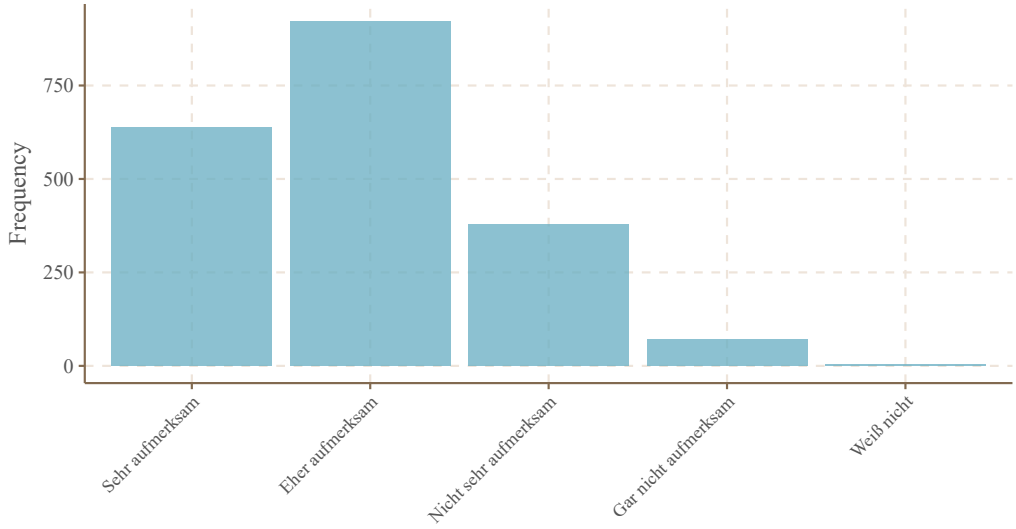

Figure 2: Vote recall

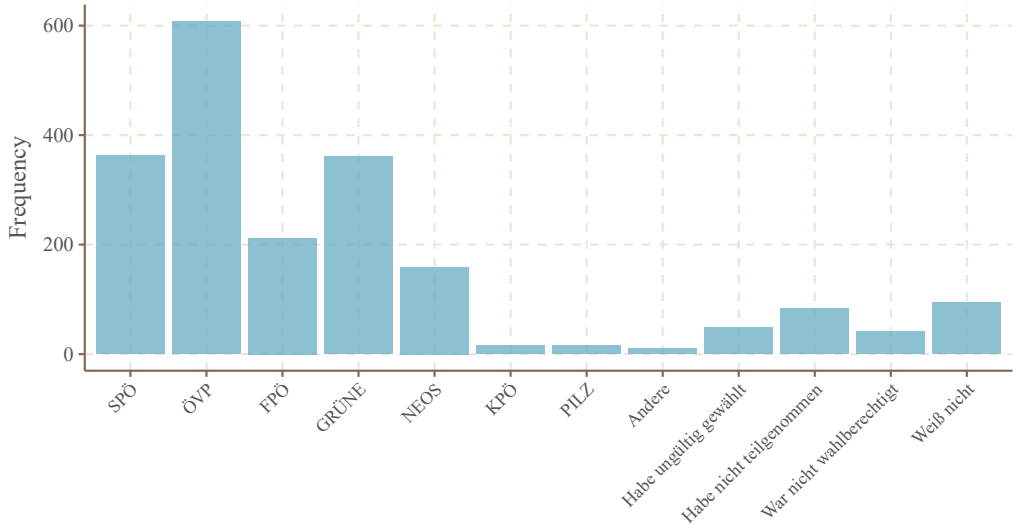

Figure 3: Propensity to vote

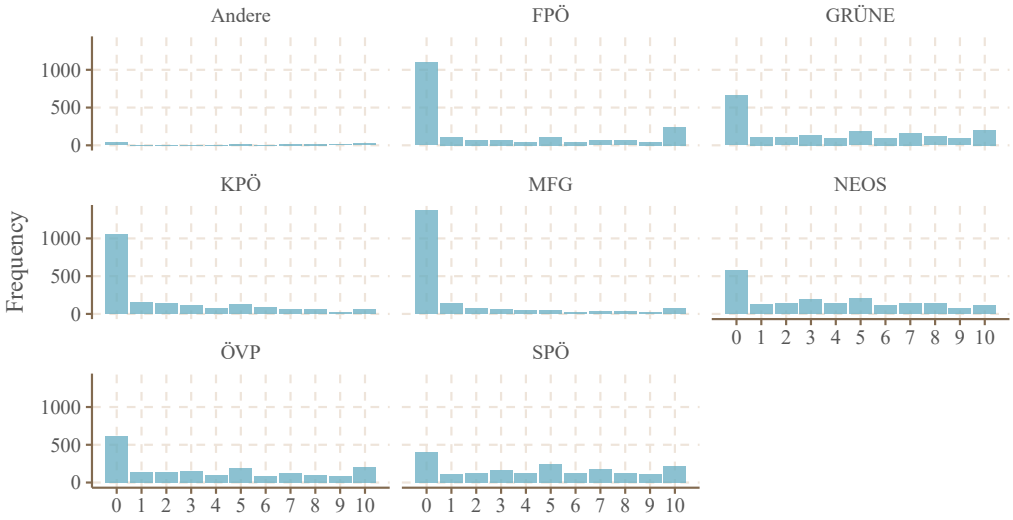

Figure 4: Party decide

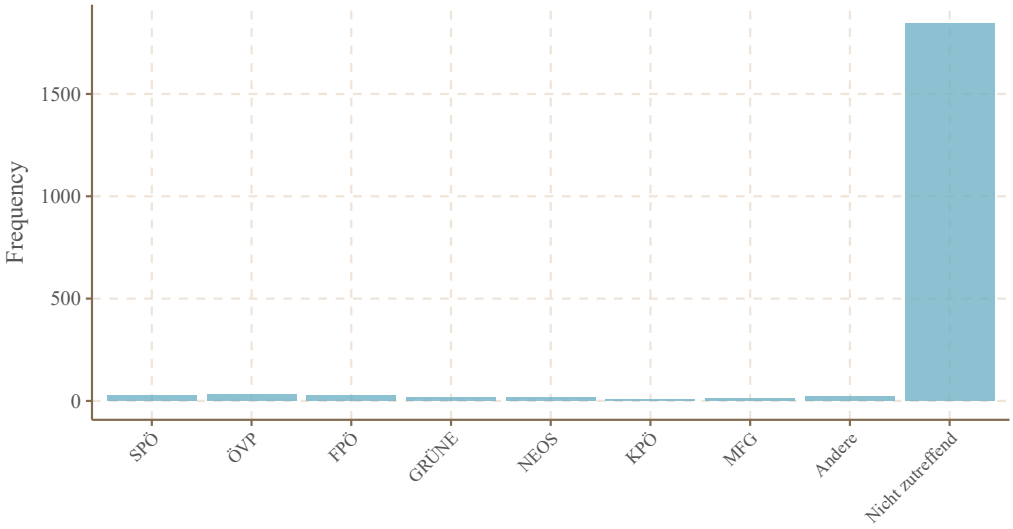

Figure 5: Participation intention

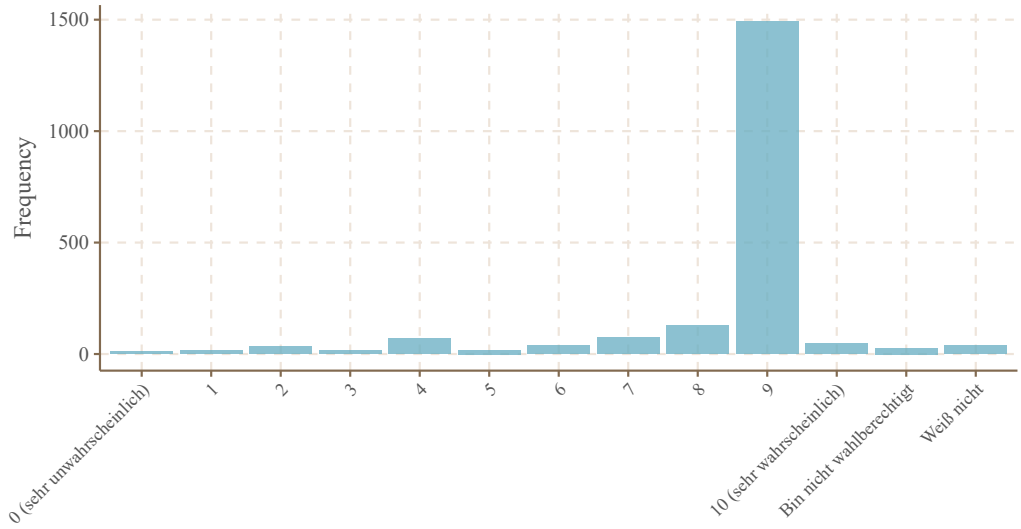

Figure 6: Populist attitudes

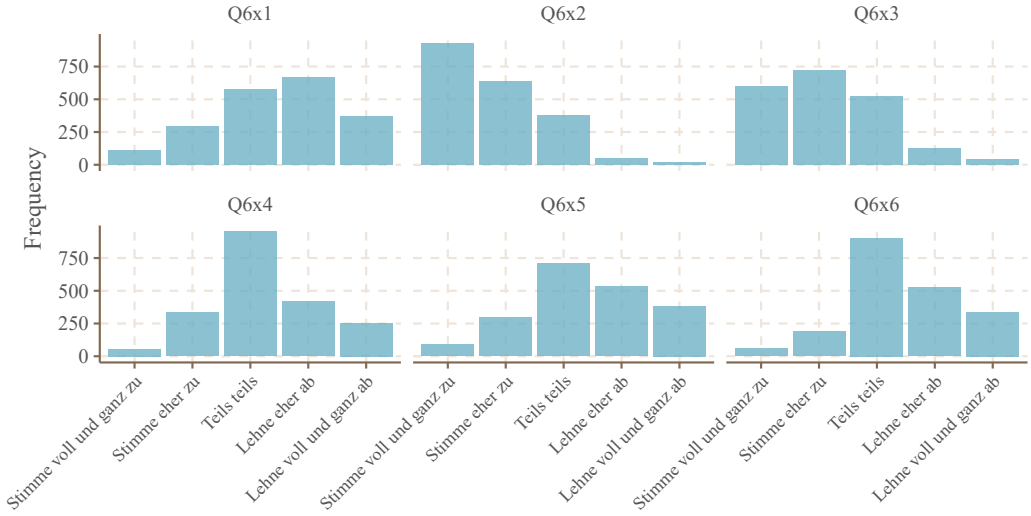

Figure 7: Representation

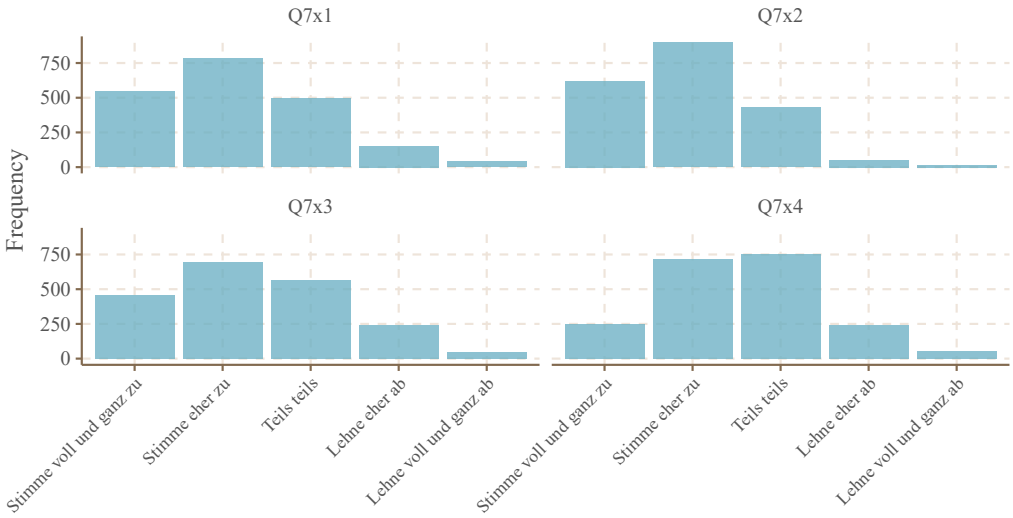

Figure 8: Policy issues

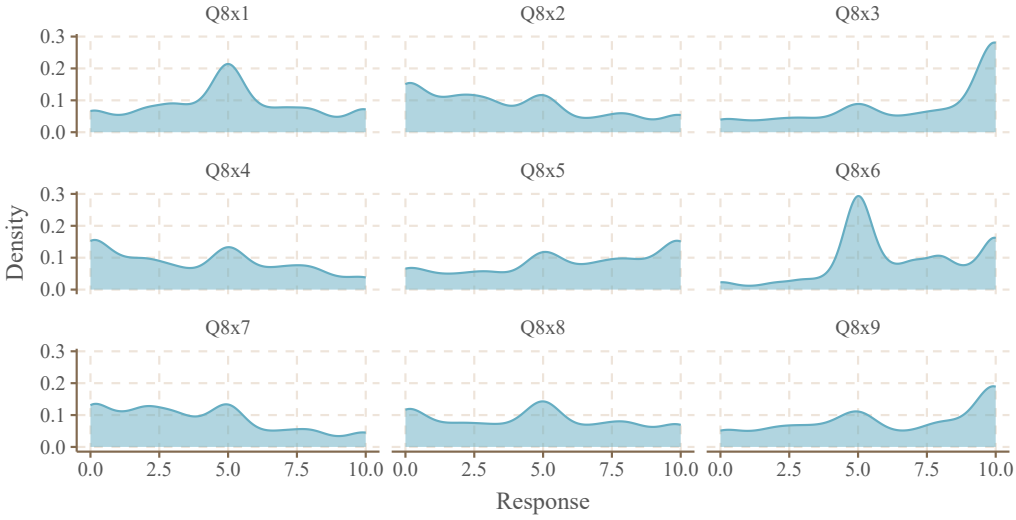

Figure 9: Commitment

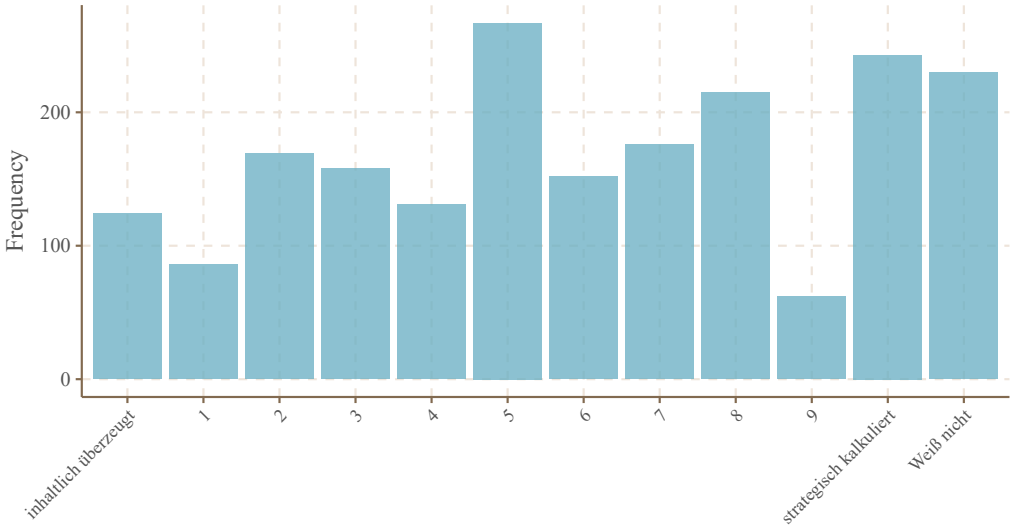

Figure 10: Ideological congruence

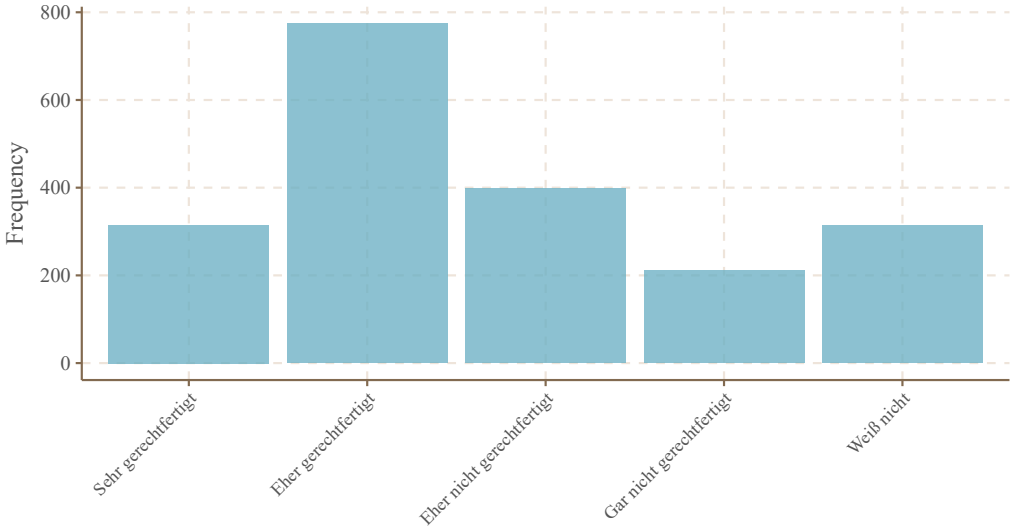

Figure 11: Propensity to vote, post−treatment

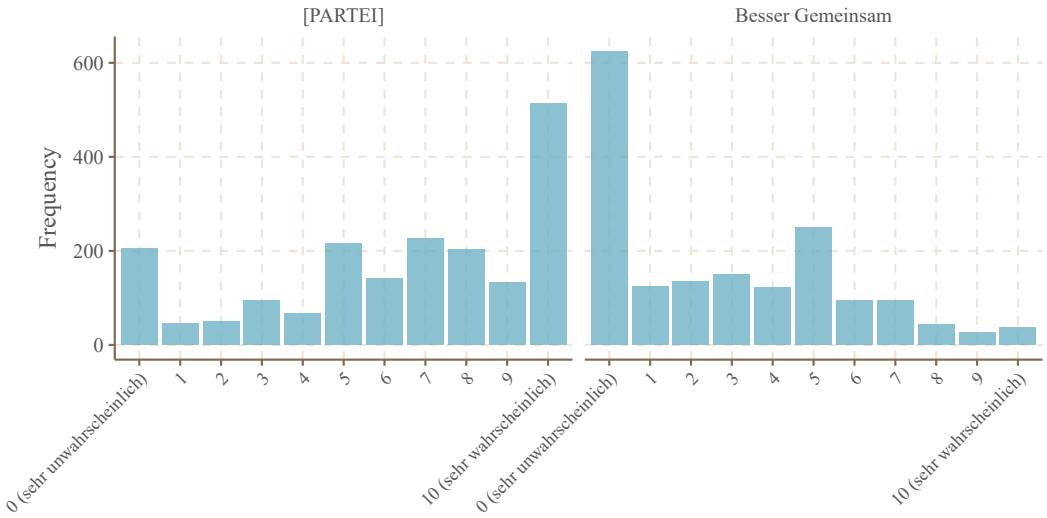

Figure 12: Participation intention, post−treatment

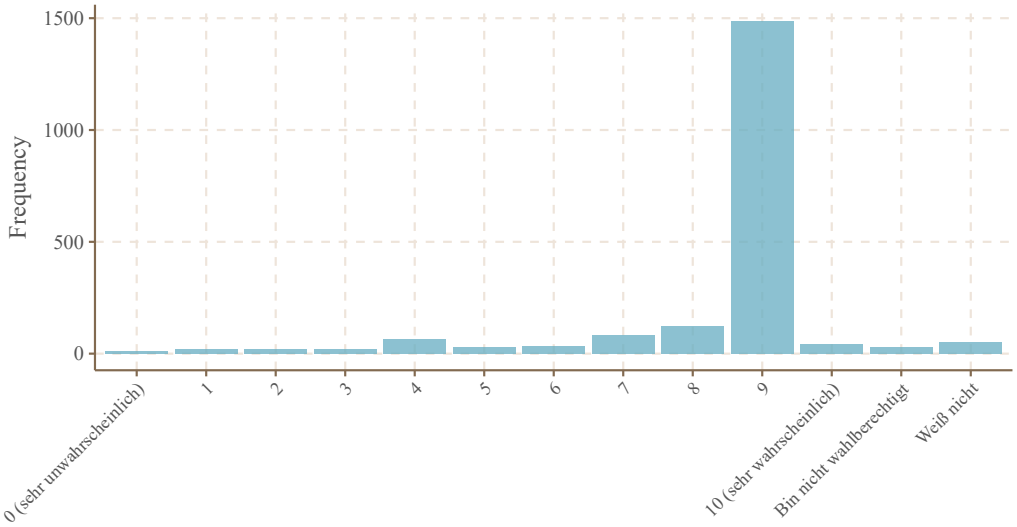

Figure 13: Populist attitudes, post−treatment

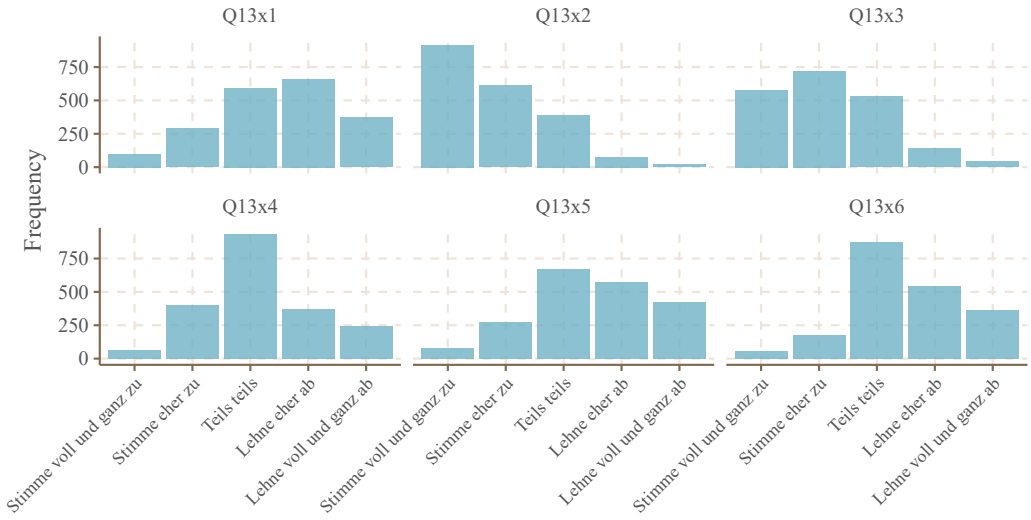

Figure 14: Attention

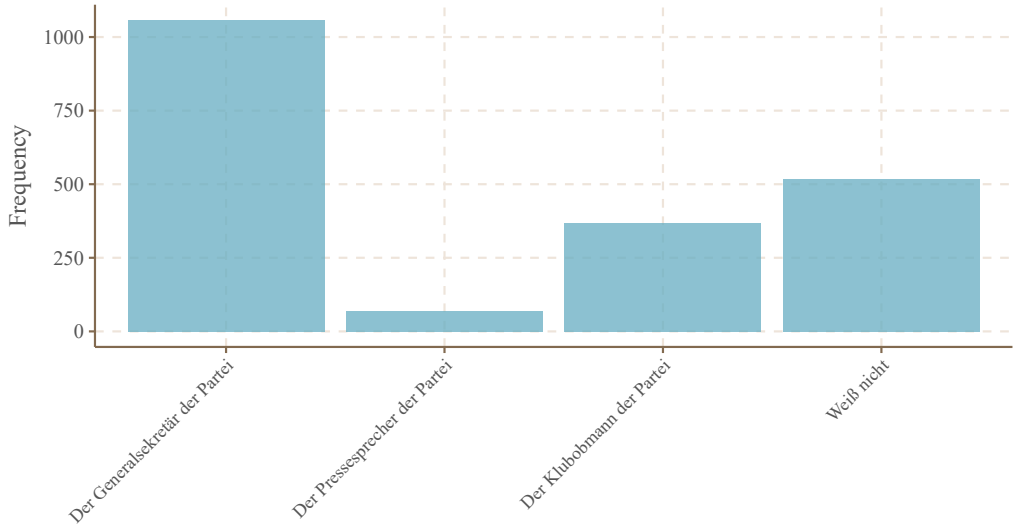

Figure 15: Challenger identity

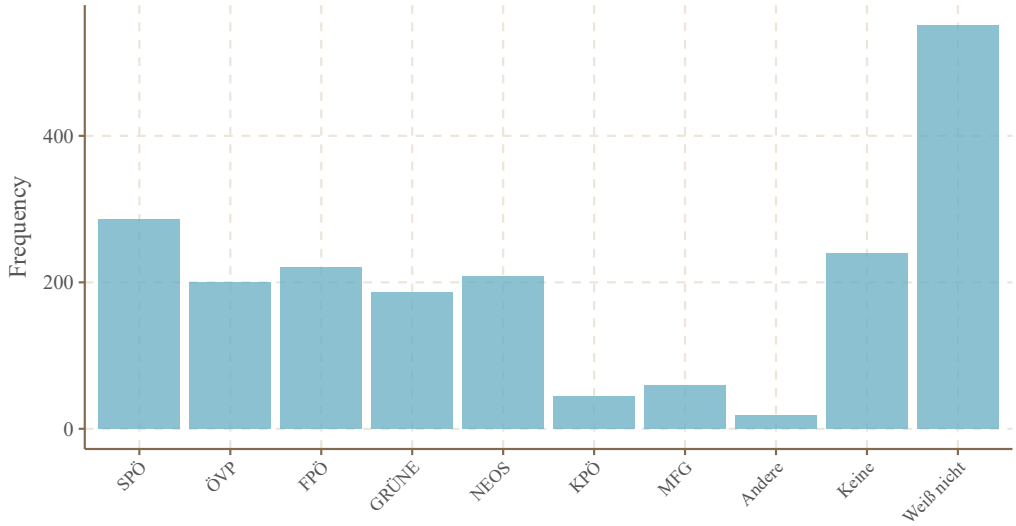

Figure 16: Gender

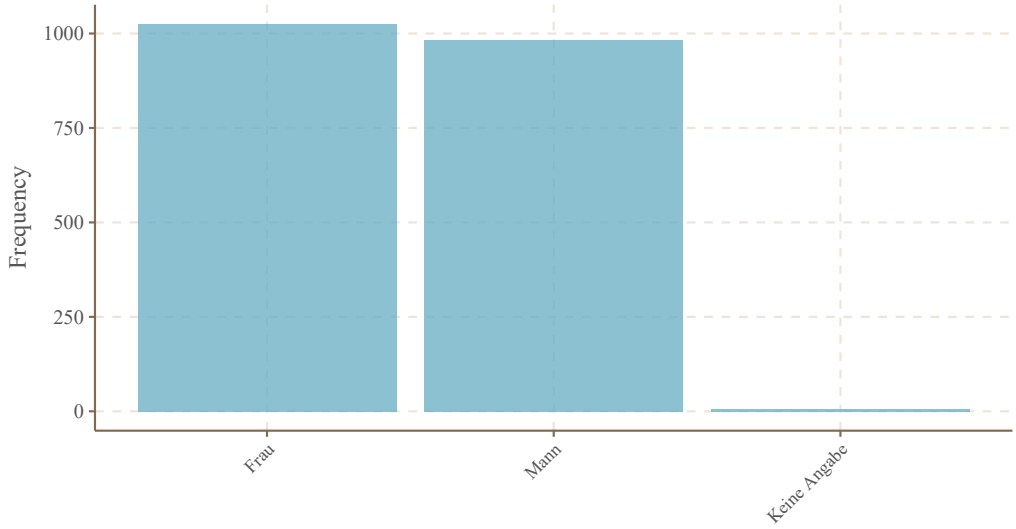

Figure 17: Age

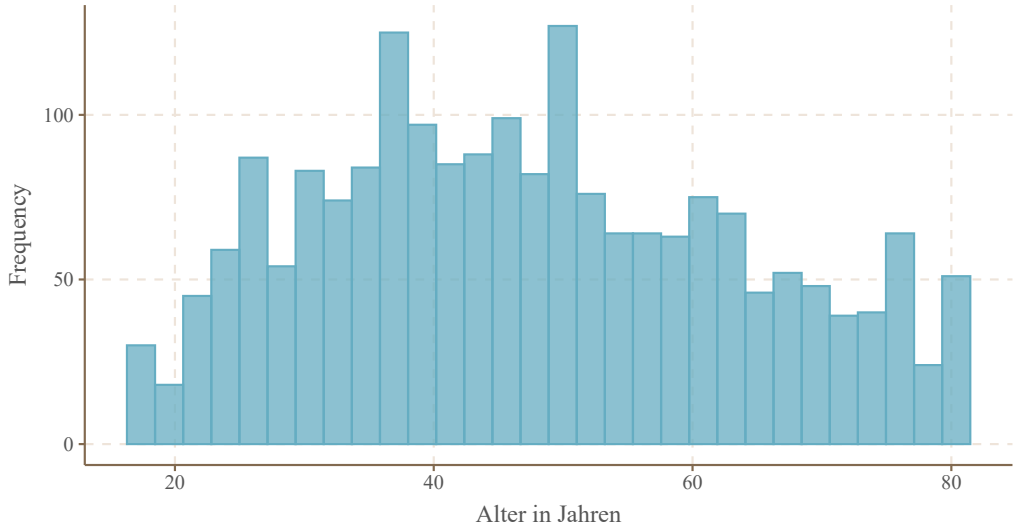

Figure 18: State

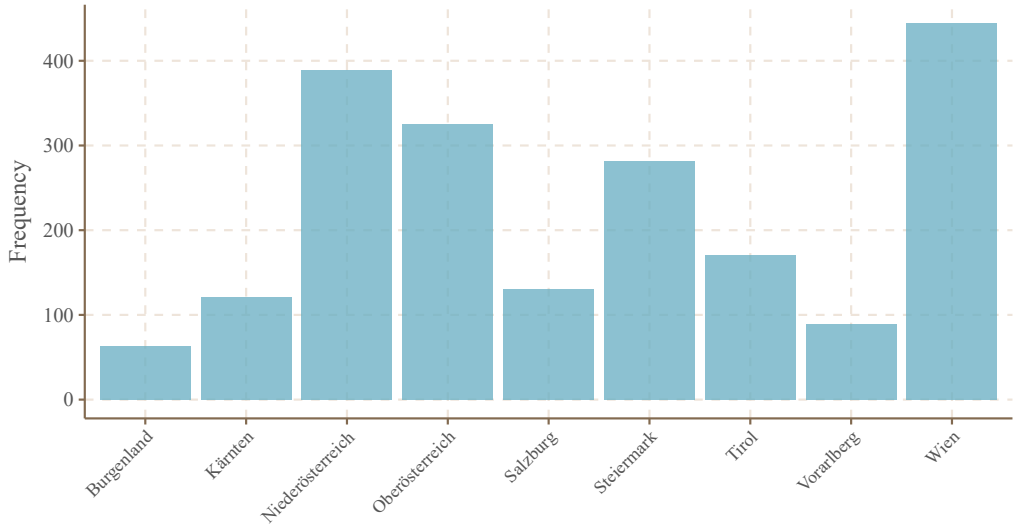

Figure 19: Education

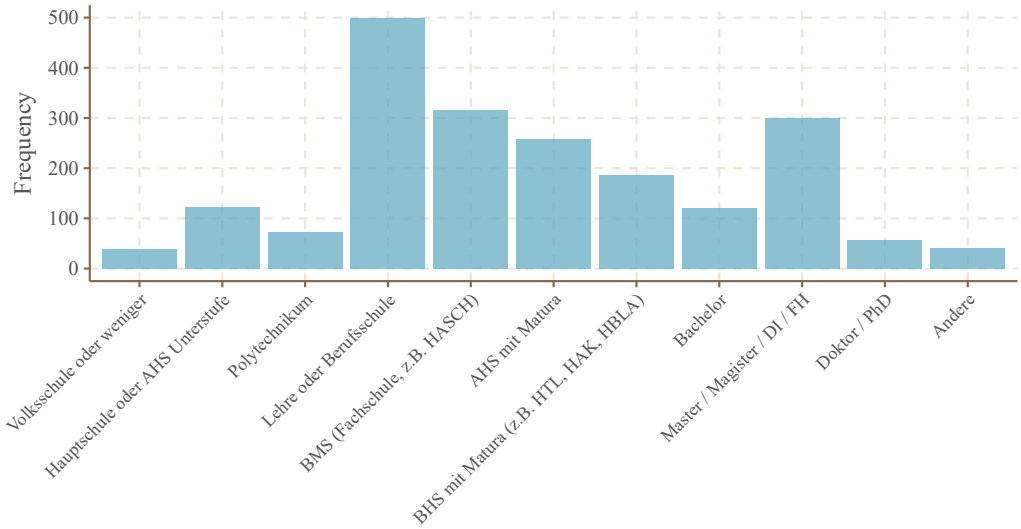

Figure 20: Employment

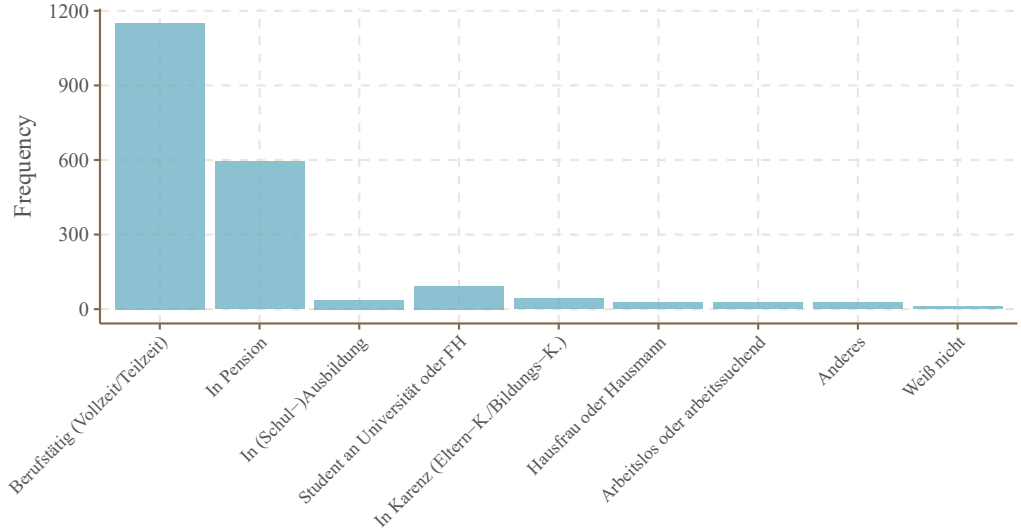
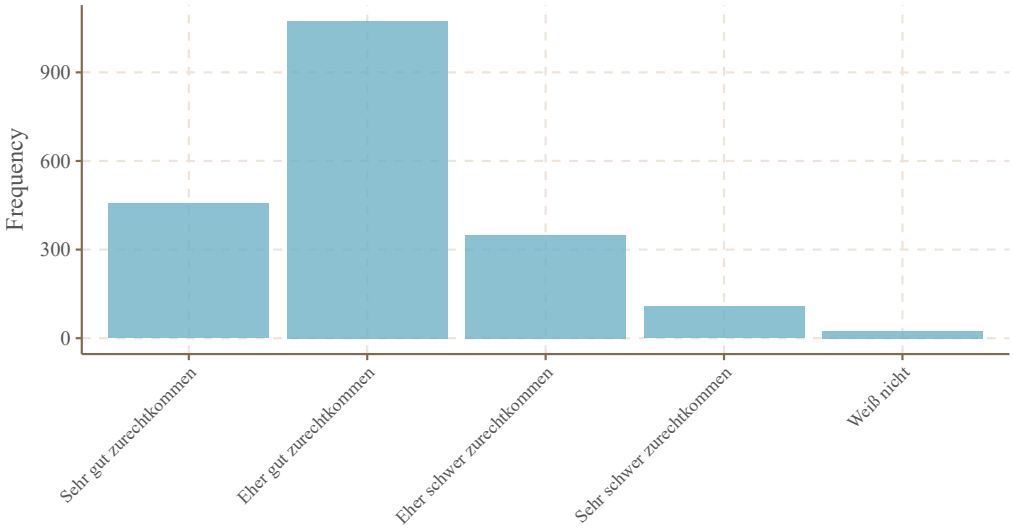
Figure 21: Income dissatisfaction